

TOWEL SYSTEM — THREE COLORS, THREE JOBS

BLUE	DISH DRYING ONLY Dry clean dishes and cookware only. Change every 1–2 days. Never on counters or hands.
GREEN	HAND DRYING ONLY Dry hands after washing only. Change every 1–2 days. Always separate from dish towel.
RED	SURFACES & SPILLS Wipe counters, spills, stovetop. Change daily. Replace immediately after raw meat contact.

TEMPERATURE DANGER ZONE

40°F

— DANGER ZONE —

140°F

bacteria doubles every 20 minutes in this range

- ! 2-HOUR RULE Cooked food left out 2+ hours → discard. 1 hour if room exceeds 90°F.
- DEFROST SAFELY Always in the refrigerator, never on the counter. Plan the night before.

FRIDGE STORAGE HIERARCHY (top to bottom)

TOP SHELF	Ready-to-eat foods, leftovers in sealed labeled containers
MIDDLE	Dairy, eggs, opened beverages, regularly used condiments
BOTTOM	Raw meat ONLY — always sealed. If it drips, it drips down.
CRISPER	Vegetables and fruit in separate drawers
DOOR	Condiments, hot sauce only — never eggs or dairy (warmest zone)

CROSS-CONTAMINATION RULES

Never rinse raw chicken — water sprays bacteria to sink, counter, nearby surfaces	Two cutting boards: one for produce, one for raw protein (use different colors)
Wash hands 20 full seconds with soap after handling raw meat — not a quick rinse	Never return cooked food to any surface, board, or plate that held raw food